

FOUNTAIN

1. Passage anchor

> “A present that I really liked was a **fountain pen** that my older sister gave me a few years ago.”

Passage meaning

In the compound **fountain pen**, **fountain** refers historically to the pen's internal reservoir or continuous supply of ink.

So:

> **fountain pen**

= **鋼筆**；**自來水筆**

The word **fountain** here does **not** mean a decorative water fountain.

Practice

1. She gave me a beautiful **fountain pen**.

她送了我一支漂亮的**鋼筆**。

2. I prefer writing with a **fountain pen** because the ink flows smoothly.

我比較喜歡用**鋼筆**寫字，因為墨水流動很順。

Core meanings of FOUNTAIN

2. fountain — structure that sends water into the air

= a structure that sends water upward or outward, usually for decoration

噴泉

Examples

1. There is a large **fountain** in the square.

廣場上有一座大型**噴泉**。

2. Children were playing near the **fountain**.

孩子們在**噴泉**附近玩。

This is the central everyday meaning.

3. water fountain

= fountain that sprays or displays water

****噴泉****

Examples

1. The garden has a stone ****water fountain****.

花園裡有一座石製****噴泉****。

2. The ****water fountain**** is lit at night.

那座****噴泉****晚上會亮燈。

Drinking-water device

4. drinking fountain

= device that provides drinking water, usually with a small upward stream

****飲水機；飲水噴泉****

Examples

1. There is a ****drinking fountain**** outside the gym.

體育館外有一台****飲水機****。

2. Students filled their bottles at the ****drinking fountain****.

學生在****飲水機****裝水。

Important distinction from decorative ****fountain****.

Natural source / spring

5. fountain — natural source of water

= natural spring or source from which water flows

****泉；泉水源頭****

Examples

1. The old text describes a sacred ****fountain****.

古文記載了一處神聖的****泉水****。

2. Water flowed from a natural ****fountain**** in the rock.

水從岩石中的天然****泉源****流出。

This sense is literary, historical, or formal in modern English.

Figurative source

6. fountain — abundant source of something

= rich or continuing source of something abstract

****源泉；來源****

Examples

1. She was a ****fountain of knowledge****.

她是知識的****泉源****。

2. The child was a ****fountain of questions****.

那個孩子的問題像****源源不絕的泉水****一樣多。

This is a productive figurative extension.

7. fountain of knowledge / wisdom

= person or source that provides a large amount of knowledge or wisdom

****知識 / 智慧的泉源****

Examples

1. The professor was a ****fountain of knowledge****.

那位教授是****知識的泉源****。

2. Older colleagues can be a ****fountain of practical wisdom****.

資深同事可以成為****實務智慧的泉源****。

Continuous flow / abundance

8. fountain of something

= continuous or abundant outpouring of something

****大量湧出的.....；源源不絕的.....****

Examples

1. The speaker produced a ****fountain of ideas****.
那位講者提出了****源源不絕的想法****。
2. The child became a ****fountain of energy**** after lunch.
那個孩子吃完午餐後變成了****精力源源不絕的人****。

This is figurative and expressive.

Fountain pen

9. fountain pen

= pen with an internal reservoir that supplies liquid ink to the nib

****鋼筆；自來水筆****

This is the exact passage compound.

Examples

1. He signed the letter with a ****fountain pen****.
他用****鋼筆****在信上簽名。
2. A ****fountain pen**** usually uses liquid ink.
****鋼筆****通常使用液體墨水。

10. fountain-pen ink

= liquid ink made for fountain pens

****鋼筆墨水****

Examples

1. This bottle contains blue ****fountain-pen ink****.
這瓶裝的是藍色****鋼筆墨水****。

2. Not every ink is suitable for a ****fountain pen****.

不是每種墨水都適合****鋼筆****使用。

Decorative / architectural extension

11. fountain feature

= decorative water installation in architecture or landscaping

****噴泉景觀；水景設施****

Examples

1. The hotel lobby includes a large ****fountain feature****.

飯店大廳有一座大型****水景設施****。

2. The garden's central ****fountain feature**** attracts visitors.

花園中央的****噴泉景觀****很吸引遊客。

This is a transparent collocation, not a separate core sense.

Related forms

12. fountainhead

= original or main source of something

****源頭；根源****

Examples

1. The city became a ****fountainhead of new ideas****.

那座城市成為新思想的****源頭****。

2. He was regarded as the ****fountainhead**** of the movement.

他被視為這場運動的****主要源頭人物****。

More literary/formal.

13. fountainlike / fountain-like

= resembling a fountain in shape or movement

****像噴泉一樣的；噴泉狀的****

Example

The sparks rose in a ****fountain-like**** pattern.

火花以****噴泉狀****向上散開。

Low priority.

High-value expressions

14. fountain of youth

= mythical source said to restore youth; figuratively, anything believed to preserve youthfulness

****青春之泉；長生不老之泉****

Examples

1. Explorers searched for the legendary ****Fountain of Youth****.

探險家尋找傳說中的****青春之泉****。

2. Exercise is sometimes jokingly called a ****fountain of youth****.

運動有時會被戲稱為****青春之泉****。

15. a fountain of information

= person or source that provides a lot of information

****資訊泉源；資訊非常豐富的人 / 來源****

Examples

1. She was a ****fountain of information**** about the city.

她對這座城市的資訊非常豐富，簡直是個****資訊泉源****。

2. The guide became a ****fountain of useful information****.

那位導遊成了****實用資訊的泉源****。

Key contrasts

16. fountain vs spring

****fountain****

= usually artificial structure that sprays water; can also be literary for a source

****噴泉 ; 泉源****

****spring****

= natural place where underground water comes to the surface

****泉 ; 泉水****

Compare:

> a city ****fountain****

> 城市噴泉

> a natural ****spring****

> 天然泉水

In modern everyday English, ****spring**** is much more natural for a natural water source.

17. fountain vs waterfall

****fountain****

= water is usually pushed or directed upward/outward

****waterfall****

= water falls downward over a natural or artificial drop

****瀑布****

18. fountain vs drinking fountain

****fountain****

by itself usually suggests a decorative water feature.

****drinking fountain****

specifically provides potable water

****飲水機 / 飲水噴泉****

19. fountain vs source

****source****

= general origin or supply of something

****來源；源頭****

****fountain****

figuratively suggests an abundant, flowing source and is more vivid/literary.

Compare:

> a source of information

> 資訊來源

> a fountain of information

> 源源不絕的資訊來源

Meaning map

The central image of ****fountain**** is:

****water flowing continuously from a source****

From this develop:

Decorative water

fountain

→ ****噴泉****

Drinking water

drinking fountain

→ ****飲水機 / 飲水噴泉****

Natural/literary source

fountain

→ ****泉源****

Figurative abundance

fountain of knowledge

→ ****知識泉源****

Writing instrument

fountain pen

→ ****鋼筆****

The passage uses the lexicalized compound:

****fountain pen****

→ ****鋼筆****

The word ****fountain**** contributes the historical idea of a continuing internal supply of ink.

MCQ-ready master list

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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fountain — decorative water structure	人工讓水向上或向外噴出的裝置；噴泉
water fountain	用作裝飾或水景的噴泉
drinking fountain	提供飲用水的設備；飲水機 / 飲水噴泉
fountain — natural/literary source	水自然湧出的泉 / 泉源，現代多偏文學或歷史語境
fountain — figurative source	大量、持續提供某事物的來源；泉源
fountain of knowledge/wisdom	能源源不絕提供知識 / 智慧的人或來源
fountain of ideas/information	想法 / 資訊非常豐富、源源不絕的來源
fountain pen	內有墨水儲存系統並持續供墨的鋼筆 / 自來水筆
fountain-pen ink	專供鋼筆使用的液體墨水
fountainhead	某事物最初或主要的來源；源頭
Fountain of Youth	傳說能令人恢復青春的青春之泉；也可比喻保持年輕的方法

Passage recap

> “...a ****fountain pen**** that my older sister gave me...”

Here:

****fountain pen**** = ****a pen that uses liquid ink supplied from an internal reservoir****

Best Traditional Chinese:

* ****鋼筆****

* more literally: ****自來水筆****

Natural contextual translation:

****我姐姐幾年前送給我的一支鋼筆。****

Passage MCQ-ready meaning

****fountain**** in ****“fountain pen”**** is part of a fixed compound referring to:

****a pen with a continuous internal supply of liquid ink****

→ ****鋼筆****

It does ****not**** mean:

> decorative ****fountain****

> → 噴泉

But the historical semantic connection is still intuitive:

****fountain****

→ something that continuously supplies liquid

****fountain pen****

→ a pen whose reservoir continuously supplies ink to the nib.